3.4.4 Improving quality

Unit 3.4 Operational management · 6 key points

- **Benefits of better quality:** fewer returns and complaints, reputation, can charge a higher price, less waste
- **Difficulties:** training costs, time, staff commitment, may slow output at first
- **Consequences of poor quality:** lost customers, rework costs, damaged brand, legal action
- **Customer expectations:** what counts as good quality depends on the price and the market
- **Measuring quality:** e.g. defect rates, returns, complaints, customer satisfaction
- Quality is especially important where a business competes on reliability